



MARKET LANDSCAPE IN PERSONAL FINANCE



WHAT FINANCE APPS DO TODAY

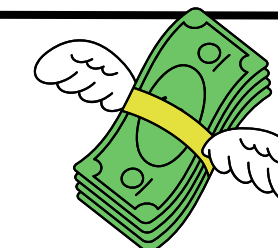
GOOGLE PAY | PHONEPE | CRED | SUPERMONEY

HOW FINANCE APPS PRESENT INSIGHTS TODAY

- MOST APPS SHOW TRANSACTION LOGS + SPENDING CATEGORIES
- INSIGHTS ARE MAINLY DELIVERED THROUGH CHARTS/DASHBOARDS AND RULE-BASED ALERTS
- EXAMPLE PATTERNS ACROSS UPI & FINTECH APPS: GOOGLE PAY / PHONEPE / CRED / SUPERMONEY



COMMON SHORTCOMINGS



CHARTS-HEAVY INSIGHTS:

SHOW WHAT, NOT WHY →
LOW INTERPRETATION

**RESULT: USERS GLANCE
AND EXIT INSTEAD OF
REFLECTING**



GENERIC SPENDING ALERTS GET IGNORED

REPETITIVE TEMPLATES →
**FATIGUE + MUTED
NOTIFICATIONS**



**RESULT: SIGNAL BECOMES
NOISE → ENGAGEMENT
COLLAPSES**

NO BEHAVIOR CONTEXT:

NO TRIGGERS/PATTERNS
→ **AWARENESS WITHOUT
CHANGE**



**RESULT: USERS GET
AWARENESS BUT NOT
UNDERSTANDING OR
CHANGE**

WHY CURRENT APPROACHES FAIL TO CHANGE BEHAVIOR

- DATA ≠ MEANING (USERS SEE NUMBERS BUT DON'T LEARN PATTERNS)
- EFFORT > REWARD (TRACKING FEELS LIKE WORK)
- EMOTIONAL FRICTION (GUILT/ANXIETY → AVOIDANCE)
- LOW RETENTION (FINANCE APPS DROP OFF OVER TIME DUE TO LOW SUSTAINED VALUE)

KEY TAKEAWAY:

FINANCE APPS REPORT SPENDING, BUT DON'T EXPLAIN BEHAVIOR, SO USERS DISENGAGE.



UNDERSTANDING THE CURRENT UX OF PHONEPE



CURRENT STATE AUDIT

What Google Pay does well today

- Fast UPI payment flow (Pay & Exit behavior is strong)
- Clean Recent transactions list
- Reliable transaction details: amount, merchant, timestamp
- Familiar UI + high trust for payments

What’s Missing for “Spending Reflection”

- No home-screen reflection layer
- Insights aren’t proactive (users must open history)
- No pattern summaries (habits / spikes / micro-spends)
- No confidence + “why shown” clarity
- No user controls (dismiss / mute / correct / confirm)
- Privacy reassurance not visible at insight moment
- Feels like raw data, not meaningful reflection

Resulting behavior

- Users use Google Pay mainly for transaction completion
- Spending insights → low discoverability
- Reflection loop breaks → users stop opening history



USER JOURNEY (TRANSACTION TO DISENGAGEMENT)

KPI TREE

Stage	What user does	Current Google Pay experience	User feeling	Outcome
Transaction	Pays via UPI	Fast “Pay & Exit” flow	Neutral	Task done
Insight moment	Looks for meaning (optional)	No proactive insights shown	Unmotivated	Skips reflection
Tries to understand	Opens History (rare)	Raw transaction list, no summary	Overwhelmed	Closes quickly
Reacts emotionally	Sees spend data	Can feel judging / too personal	Defensive	Avoids checking again
Disengagement	Returns next week	No habit loop built	Detached	Stops opening insights



CHOSEN USER SEGMENT AND THE PAIN POINTS



PROBLEM STATEMENT

Google Pay enables frequent UPI payments, but offers limited support for spending reflection—resulting in low awareness of where money goes and reduced engagement with reviewing habits.

TARGET SEGMENT

Daily UPI Salary Spenders (₹30K+ / month)

Working professionals (21–34 years) who use Google Pay daily for routine payments (food, commute, groceries, subscriptions) and treat it as a fast payment utility, not a spending reflection tool.

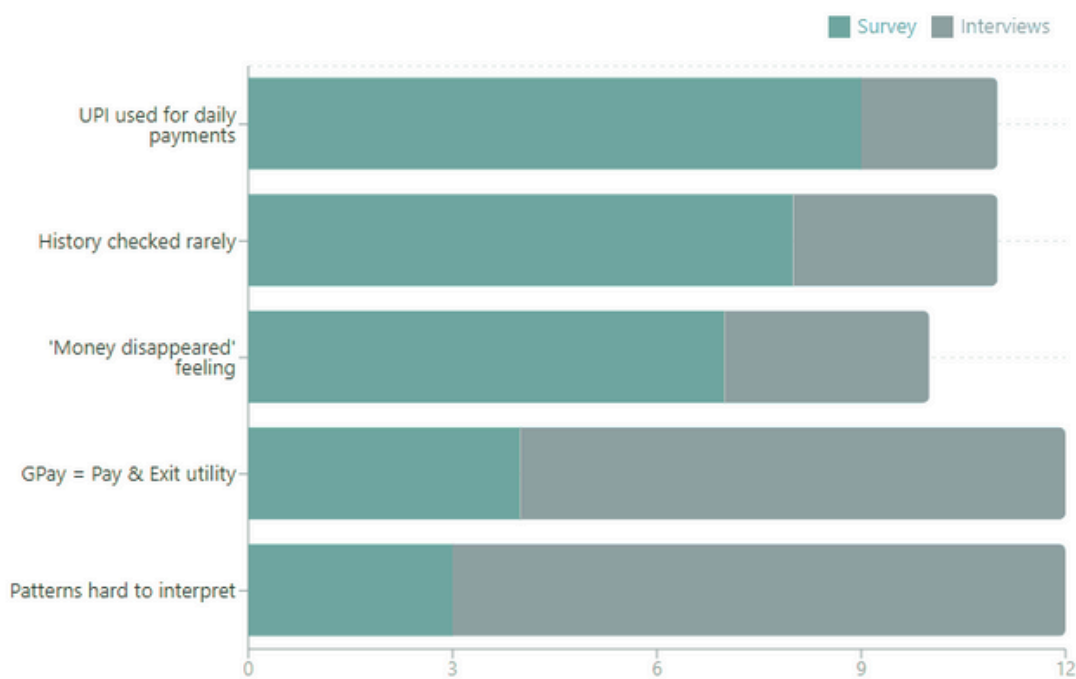
HYPOTHESIS

- Validated: Users treat GPay as a utility, not a reflection tool
- Invalidated: Rewards are required for insight engagement
- Invalidated: Spending behavior is the same across UPI apps

PAIN POINTS

Pain Point	What Users Feel / Do	Interview Signal
“Salary disappears” feeling	Daily spends feel small and harmless, but salary seems to vanish fast	Users notice overspending only near month-end
GPay is a utility, not a reflection tool	They open Google Pay only to complete payments, not to analyze	Called GPay “reliable”, “frictionless”, “for daily payments”
No clear recall of intent behind spends	Even after seeing history, users can’t remember <i>why</i> a payment happened	Transactions blend together, no meaningful “reason” attached
Review feels stressful	Checking spends feels uncomfortable, so they avoid it	Reflection happens rarely / feels like effort + guilt

INSIGHTS FROM SURVEY / USER INTERVIEWS



Why 5 Bars? (Top Insights Chosen)	What it Represents
UPI used for daily payments	High transaction frequency creates
History checked rarely	Reflection doesn't start because
“Money disappeared”	Users feel loss of control at month-
GPay = Pay & Exit utility	App is used for speed, not
Patterns hard to interpret	Raw list makes habits + repeats

SURVEY INSIGHTS

- **UPI** is the primary mode for most daily payments
- Users check transaction history **rarely / occasionally**
- **“Where did my money go?”** feeling happens often
- **Auto-spending** (paying without thinking) is common

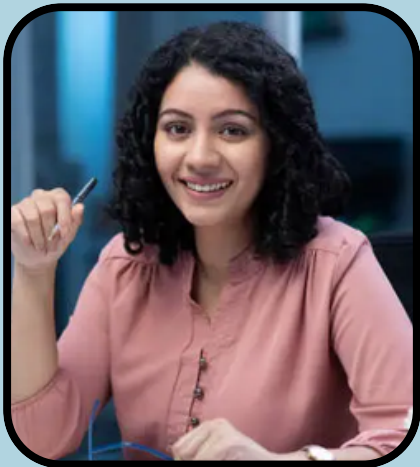
INTERVIEW INSIGHTS

- **Google Pay** is preferred for being reliable + frictionless
- Users open **GPay** to pay quickly, not to **review spends**
- **Transaction history** lacks context, making recall difficult
- App preference differs by segment(**CRED = rewards; Paytm/PhonePe <₹30K Salary**)



Name: Arjun Mehta USER PERSONAS
Age: 27 Years
Profession & Salary: Business Analyst - ₹50K/month

Pain Points: Frequent small spends blend together and the transaction history feels like a raw list that’s hard to interpret.
Needs: A quick summary of recurring spends and top categories with low effort and no manual tracking.



Name: Riya Khanna
Age: 30 Years
Profession & Salary: Product Marketing Manager - ₹1.2L/month

Pain Points: She rarely opens transaction history, so spending adds up silently and money feels like it “disappears.”
Needs: Passive weekly/monthly insights that are quick, non-intrusive, and easy to scan.



FRAMING THE PROBLEM PROVING THE VALUE



What is the true problem?

Google Pay is designed for fast UPI payments, not spending reflection

- Daily salary spends happen via small, **frequent transactions** → patterns go unnoticed
- Transaction history feels like a raw list, not a **meaningful summary**
- Users feel money “**disappears**” and don’t build a **habit of review**

Who are the customers facing the problem?

- **Daily UPI Salary Spenders** (₹30K+/month)
- Working professionals (22–35) using Google Pay daily for **routine spends**
- Persona types observed:
 - **Minimal Checker** (~₹50K): checks history **rarely** but finds it unhelpful
 - **Zero Checker** (>₹1L): almost never checks history unless something **fails**

How do we know it is a real problem?

- Users make **frequent UPI payments**, so spends happen in many small transactions.
- Most users **rarely** check transaction history or balances.
- “Where did **my money** go?” is a recurring **end-of-month** feeling.
- Google Pay is used mainly for **quick payments**, so patterns aren’t noticed.

What is the value generated by solving this problem?

FOR THE TARGET CUSTOMERS

- **Instant clarity**: See where salary is going without **digging through history**
- **Repeat pattern visibility**: Spot **recurring** spends (food, commute, subscriptions) fast
- **Less stress**: Fewer “money disappeared” moments without **manual tracking**

FOR THE BUSINESS (GOOGLE PAY)

- **More engagement**: Users interact beyond “**pay & exit**” (history/insights)
- **Better retention**: Reflection touchpoints increase retention over time
- **Differentiation**: Google Pay becomes not just **reliable**, but also **helpful** for awareness

Why should we solve this problem now?

- UPI usage is at **peak** → **rich** transaction data is generated daily
- Google Pay already has **trust + habit**, easiest place to introduce reflection
- Competitors win via rewards, but GPay can win via **clarity + usefulness**
- Expands Google Pay from utility-only to a **more valuable daily money product**



IDEATING POTENTIAL EVIDENCE-LED SOLUTIONS



Spending Snapshot



Concept (WHAT): A simple weekly/monthly snapshot showing top spends + repeat categories.

Evidence: Users check history rarely, but still face “money disappeared” moments.

What it solves: Builds passive awareness for users who don’t review transactions.

Pattern Explainer Layer



- **Concept (WHAT):** Converts raw transaction history into clear patterns (repeat spends, spikes, drift).
- **Evidence:** GPay is used as a “pay & exit” utility, and history feels like a raw list.
- **What it solves:** Turns transaction history into a quick, understandable behavior summary.

Smart Context Tags

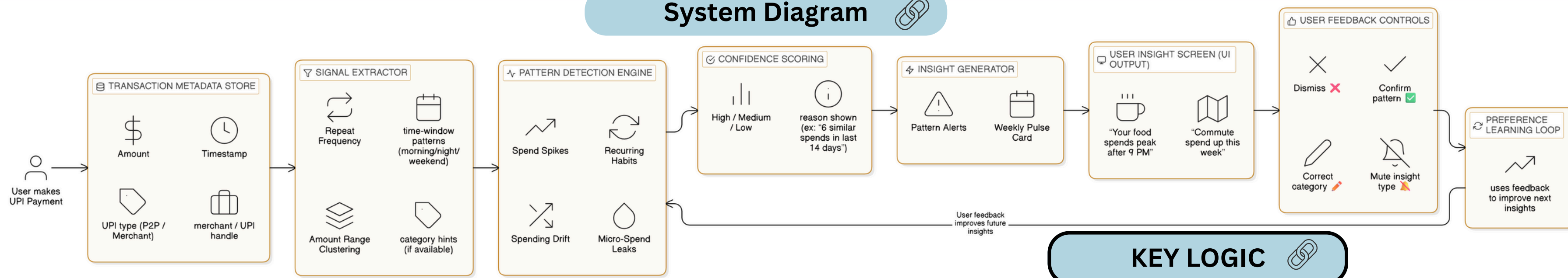


- **Concept (WHAT):** Optional tagging like “Need / Want / Habit” or quick note prompts.
- **Evidence:** Users struggle to recall intent behind frequent small spends.
- **What it solves:** Adds context over time, but requires user effort.

Why We Prioritized Pattern Explainer Layer

It directly addresses the **biggest validated gap** from research: data exists, but **interpretation** is missing.

- Users make **frequent UPI payments**, but rarely review **transaction history**
- **Biggest gap** is meaning, not **missing data**
- **Explainer layer** surfaces repeat patterns with **minimal effort**
- Aligns with Google Pay’s **trust-first utility** perception
- **AI-feasible** using existing signals (**frequency, repeats, time, merchants**)



KEY LOGIC



Solution Deep Dive	What AI does	How it helps your problem
Inputs used	Amount, time, merchant/UPI	Uses only payment data → no privacy
Patterns detected	Repeat habits, spend spikes, micro-	Turns frequent UPI spends into
Uncertainty handling	Confidence: High/Med/Low +	Builds trust by avoiding wrong or
User sees / when / why	Weekly Pulse + Pattern Alerts (only	Fits users who rarely check history
User controls	Confirm / Dismiss / Correct category / Mute	User stays in control → emotionally safe + improves future insights

Logic Area	What happens	Why it matters
Inputs	Metadata only (amount, time, merchant, UPI type)	Privacy-safe
Patterns	Detects repeats, spikes, drift, micro-leaks	Adds meaning
Confidence	High/Med/Low + “why shown”	Builds trust
Delivery	Weekly Pulse + high-signal alerts	Low noise
User control	Confirm / dismiss / correct / mute	User stays in control



KEY SUCCESS METRICS AND RISKS & MITIGATION

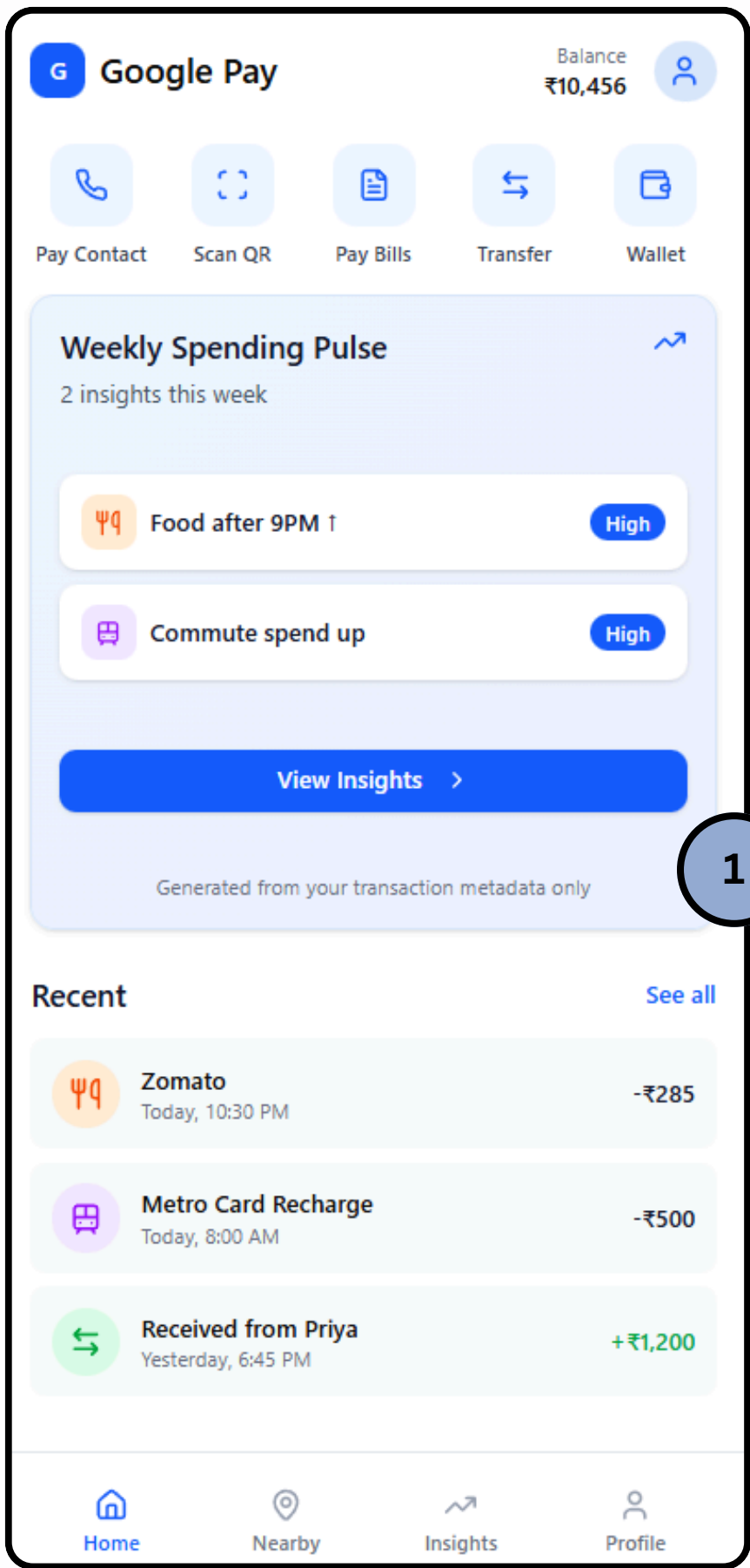


KEY SUCCESS METRICS

Stage	Metric	Why this matches research
Adoption	Weekly Pulse views/user/week	Users rarely check history → Pulse must be seen
Understanding (North Star)	% insights confirmed vs dismissed	Measures if patterns make sense to users
Understanding	Avg time on Pulse card (≤10s)	Reflection must stay frictionless like GPay
Trust (North Star)	“Insight felt accurate” rating (1–5)	Prevents trust loss from wrong patterns
Guardrail	Mute/opt-out rate	Checks emotional safety + intrusion risk
Retention	Repeat Pulse viewers (weekly)	Sustained reflection beyond “pay & exit”

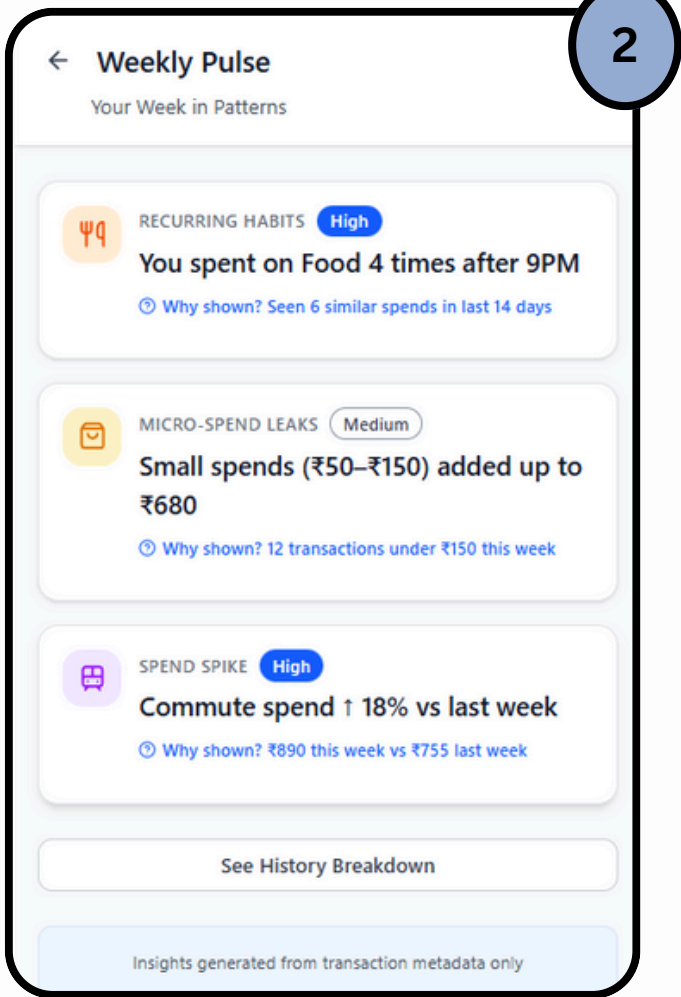
RISKS & MITIGATION

Risk	Mitigation Strategy
Users still don’t open insights	Pulse card on home + scan-in-5s format
Wrong insights reduce trust	Confidence + “why shown” + quick dismiss/correct
Too many insights = annoyance	Cap 2–3 insights/week, prioritize Pulse over alerts
“Guilt/judgement” response	Neutral language, no overspend framing, mute option
Merchant naming misclassification	Category correction + learning loop
Privacy fear → opt-out	Metadata-only, explicit consent, opt-out anytime



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Users see light insights on Home, no need to open history.



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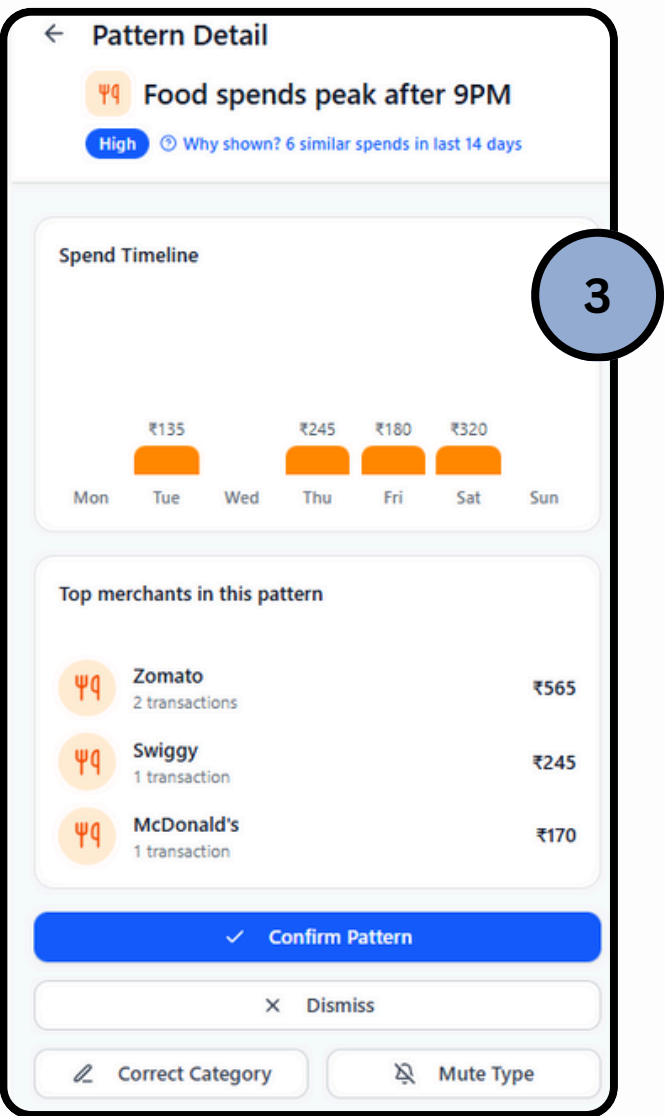
Weekly Pulse summarizes patterns with confidence + “why shown.”



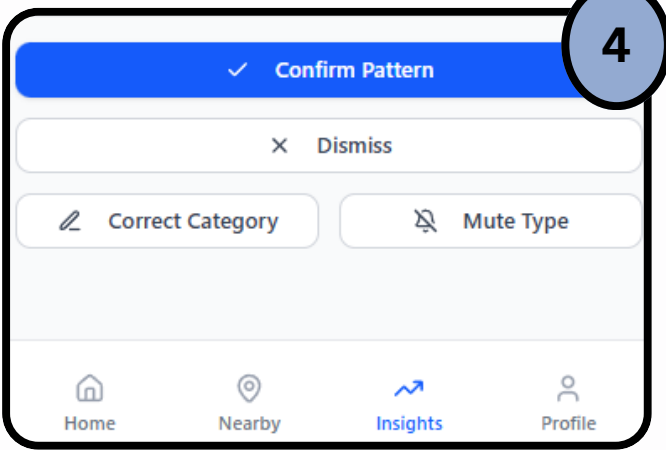
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Explains pattern using timeline + top merchants for transparency.

Simple feedback builds trust and reduces noise in insights.

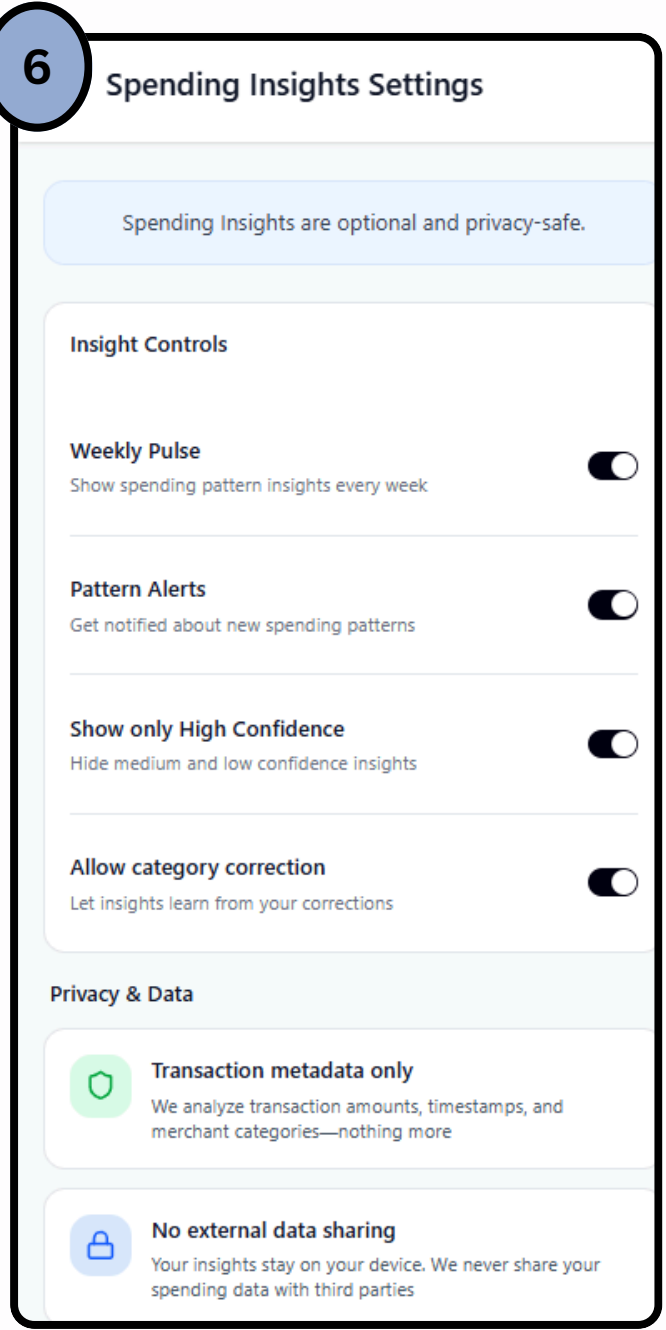


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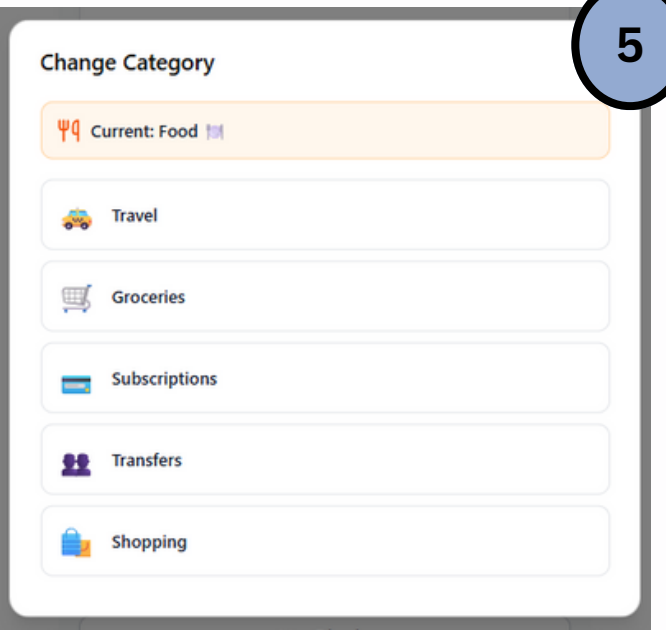


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User stays in control: confirm, dismiss, mute, or correct category.



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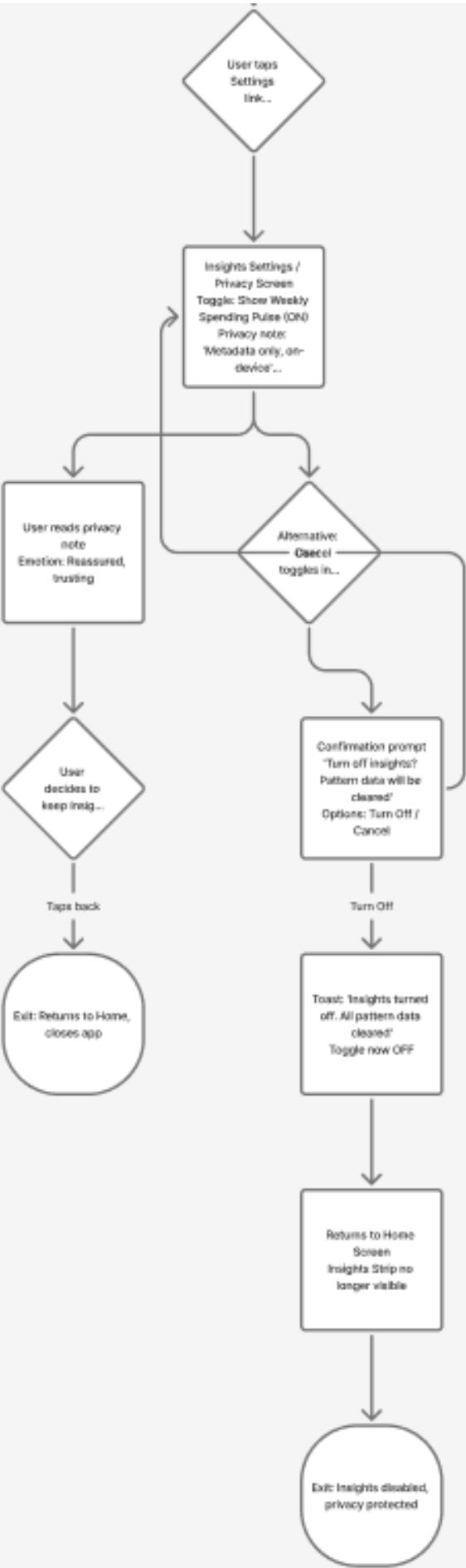
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Micro-feedback keeps insights emotionally safe + improves relevance

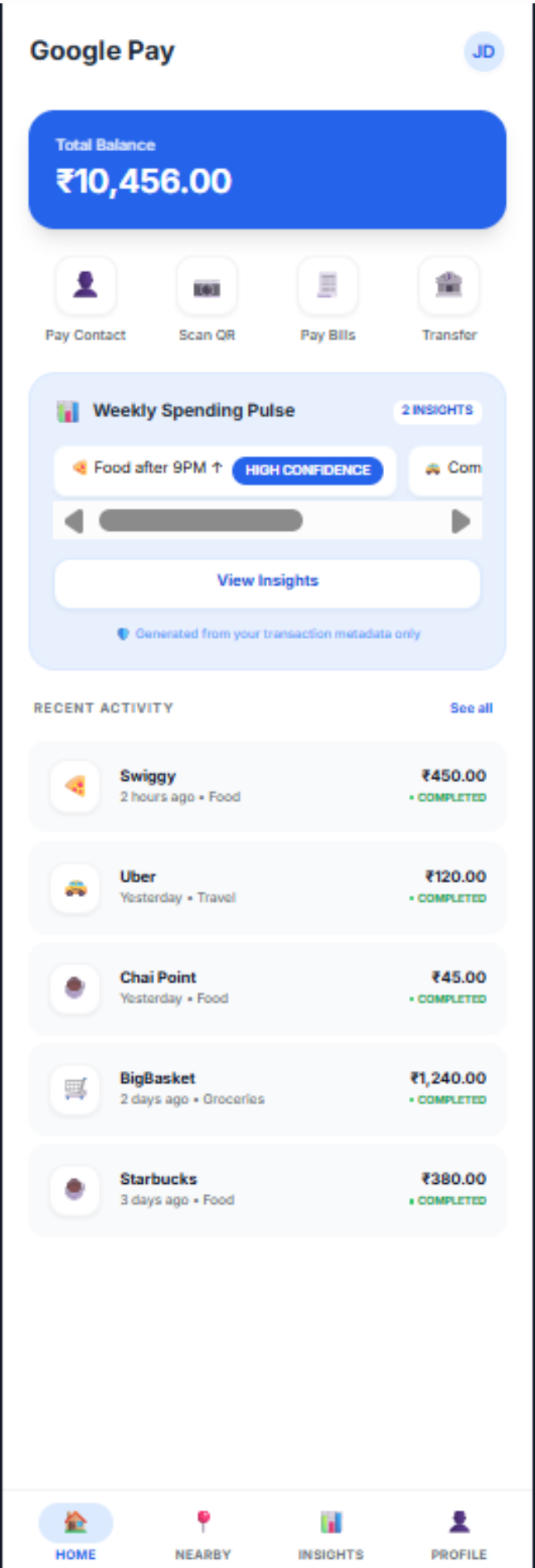
LINK TO WIRE FRAME

Insights are optional, (metadata-only) and can be turned off anytime

USER FLOW



LINK TO WORKING PROTOTYPE



DOCS FOR PROMPTS USED



“TO STRUCTURE THE CASE STUDY EFFICIENTLY, I DOCUMENTED THE PRODUCT GOAL, AUDITED THE CURRENT GOOGLE PAY SPENDING EXPERIENCE, MAPPED THE USER JOURNEY DROP-OFFS, AND DEFINED KEY DESIGN PRINCIPLES (NON-JUDGMENTAL, CONFIDENCE-BASED, EXPLAINABLE, PRIVACY-SAFE). BASED ON THIS, I OUTLINED DETAILED SCREEN REQUIREMENTS AND REFINED MICROCOPY FOR AN EMOTIONALLY SAFE REFLECTION FLOW. TOOL PROMPTS WERE USED ONLY TO GENERATE INITIAL UI DRAFTS AND KPI DIAGRAMS IN FIGMA/WHIMSICAL, WHICH WERE THEN REFINED MANUALLY FOR CONSISTENCY AND CLARITY.”